

11. Source: Meeting with representatives of the Patient Association of Beta Town

Report: Meeting with Patient Association Representatives in Beta Town, which included many local tribespeople

Upon arrival in Beta Town, the Health for All (HfA) delegation was approached by representatives from the Patient Association, the same group that led the recent demonstration outside HfA's local office.

The Patient Association began by expressing gratitude to HfA for visiting Beta Town, seeing it as a sign of the organization's acknowledgment of its crucial role in healthcare delivery in the region. The Association is eager to collaborate with HfA to restore hospital services.

They presented HfA with a list of patients requiring urgent surgical intervention, highlighting two individuals injured in a recent road accident who are currently without medical attention at their homes. The representatives also showed photos of children bearing scars and deformities from past inadequate treatments, emphasizing HfA's responsibility in ensuring these children receive necessary care to lead normal lives, including returning to school.

Furthermore, the Association alerted HfA to a growing number of measles cases in the district, causing considerable alarm among local families. They urge HfA to spearhead vaccination campaigns, given the lack of substantial assistance from the national government on this front.

In a concerning revelation, the representatives mentioned the financial struggles of the district's residents. With the ongoing issues at the local hospital, many are left with no choice but to seek expensive healthcare services in the capital. The Association fears that in the absence of funds, locals might turn to tribal affiliations to pressure organizations, including HfA, for financial resources.

The crux of the discussion underscored the urgency of reinstating healthcare services at the local hospital. The Association firmly believes that immediate action will prevent further strain on relationships with humanitarian entities.

The HfA delegation from Geneva listened intently to the concerns and requests presented by the Patient Association, inviting their support in ensuring the release of the staff and their return to their duty at the hospital.